

SHORTLIST AT A GLANCE

Platform	Strength	Weakness	Ideal Use
Zabbix 6.4	1-minute polling, built-in web-synthetic checks, auto-registration	Steeper learning curve	Mixed infra: routers, servers, SaaS
Prometheus 2.48	Pull-based metrics, PromQL analytics, Kubernetes native	Lacks SNMP traps out of box	App-heavy or container shops
LibreNMS 24.4	Zero-touch autodiscovery, SNMP trap daemon, mobile app	Heavier MySQL backend	Switch-centric, MSP views



Dashboards, Extensibility. Weight them 30/30/25/15 and score each platform:

	Zabbix	Prometheus	LibreNMS
Discovery	25	18	28
Alerting	27	23	24
Dashboards	23	26	20
Extensibility	12	15	12
TOTAL	87	82	84

Take-away: Zabbix edges out when you need broad protocol coverage; Prometheus wins if DevOps owns monitoring; LibreNMS shines for plug-and-play device maps.

Hands-On Lab: Deploy Zabbix in 15 Minutes on Ubuntu 22.04

- Prep box:** `sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y nginx mysql-server php8.1 php8.1-mysql snmp snmpd`

Add repo and install:

```
wget https://repo.zabbix.com/zabbix/6.4/ubuntu/pool/main/z/zabbix-release/zabbix-release_6.4-1ubuntu22.04_all.deb
sudo dpkg -i zabbix-release_6.4-1ubuntu22.04_all.deb
sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y zabbix-
```

```
server-mysql zabbix-frontend-php zabbix-agent2
```

Secure MySQL: `mysql_secure_installation`, then create DB and user:

```
CREATE DATABASE zabbix CHARACTER SET utf8mb4
COLLATE utf8mb4_bin;
CREATE USER 'zbx'@'localhost' IDENTIFIED BY 'StrongPass!';
GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON zabbix.* TO 'zbx'@'localhost';
FLUSH PRIVILEGES;
```

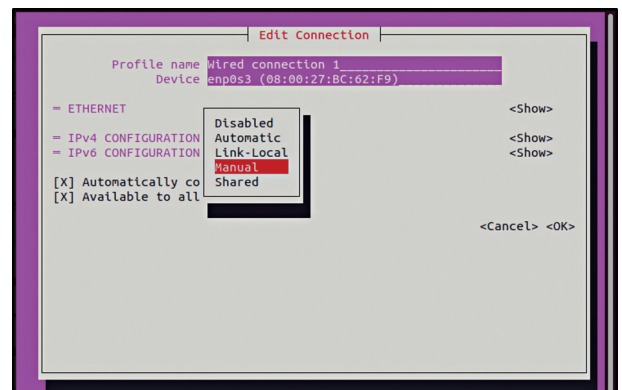
Import schema:

```
zcat /usr/share/doc/zabbix-server-mysql*/create.sql.gz | mysql -uzbx -p zabbix
```

Configure `zabbix_server.conf`: set `DBPassword=StrongPass!` then start services:

```
sudo systemctl enable --now zabbix-server
zabbix-agent2 nginx mysql.
```

Browse: `http://<server-IP>/zabbix`; complete the wizard.



First device auto-registration

Navigate → Configuration → Actions → Auto-registration; add rule "if host metadata contains SNMP" → link Linux SNMP template → add to group 'Switches'. Your core switch appears within 60 seconds, graphs ready.